

Strategic Communications Plan

Community Infrastructure Upgrade

Illustrative project: Riverside Active Travel & Streetscape Upgrade

ILLUSTRATIVE SAMPLE

Purpose

This sample demonstrates the structure, thinking and level of detail that can be used for a client deliverable. The project is fictional and the content is illustrative. Every client plan is tailored to the brief, organisation, stakeholders, risks and operating environment.

1. Project overview

Riverside Council is planning a staged upgrade of a busy neighbourhood corridor to improve pedestrian safety, cycling connections, drainage, landscaping and public amenity. Construction is expected to affect residents, local businesses, road users, public transport customers and community facilities over approximately eight months.

COMMUNICATION OBJECTIVE

Build understanding of why the works are happening, provide timely and practical information about impacts, and maintain confidence through clear, consistent and responsive communication before and during delivery.

2. Communications objectives

- Explain the purpose, benefits, timing and stages of the upgrade in plain English.
- Give affected audiences enough notice to plan around access, traffic, parking and construction impacts.
- Provide consistent information across project teams and communication channels.
- Create simple pathways for questions, feedback and issue escalation.
- Support the project team to respond quickly if timings or impacts change.

3. Audience priorities

Audience	What matters most	Communication need
Directly affected residents	Access, noise, timing, property impacts	Early, specific and localised updates
Local businesses	Customer access, parking, deliveries	Advance notice and direct contact
Road users & commuters	Detours, delays, changed conditions	Simple, timely travel information
Schools / community facilities	Safety, peak times, access	Targeted liaison and practical updates

Audience	What matters most	Communication need
Wider community	Benefits, progress, disruptions	Concise project updates and milestones

4. Message framework

Message area	Illustrative message
Why	The upgrade is designed to make Riverside Road safer, easier to move through and more resilient for the future.
What	Works include pathway improvements, safer crossings, drainage upgrades, landscaping and changes to parts of the road corridor.
Impact	Access will be maintained where practical, but temporary traffic, parking and pedestrian changes will occur as work moves through each stage.
Commitment	The project team will provide advance notice of significant changes and update affected properties directly when local impacts change.
Action	Check the project webpage for current information and contact the project team if you have an access requirement or concern.

5. Channel and tactics matrix

Tactic	Audience	Timing	Purpose
Project webpage	All	Always current	Single source of truth
Resident / business letter	Directly affected	2–3 weeks before works	Explain local impacts and contact pathway
Works notification	Affected properties	5–7 days before change	Confirm timing, access and disruption
EDM / newsletter	Subscribers & community	Monthly / milestones	Progress, upcoming activity, benefits
Social media	Wider community	Key changes / milestones	Awareness and traffic to webpage
On-site signage	Road users / pedestrians	During works	Immediate wayfinding and safety information

6. Tone and content principles

- Lead with what the audience needs to know, not internal project detail.
- Use precise dates and locations whenever confirmed.
- Acknowledge disruption without overstating or minimising it.
- Separate confirmed information from indicative timing.
- Use one project contact point and keep the webpage as the source of truth.

7. Communications action plan

Phase	Action	Lead	Timing
Pre-construction	Publish project overview and FAQ	Comms	4 weeks prior
Pre-construction	Letter-drop affected residents and businesses	Project + Comms	2–3 weeks prior
Mobilisation	Issue detailed works notification	Comms	5–7 days prior
Delivery	Update webpage and stakeholder messaging	Comms	As conditions change
Delivery	Monthly progress update	Project + Comms	Monthly
Milestone	Promote completed stage / next stage	Comms	At milestones
Completion	Thank-you and project outcome update	Comms	At completion

8. Issues and communication risks

Risk	Communication response
Programme changes create conflicting information	Confirm the latest approved position before publishing and timestamp online updates.
Businesses feel impacts were not communicated early enough	Prioritise direct contact and advance notice for access, parking and delivery changes.
Technical language causes confusion	Translate construction terminology into audience impacts and practical actions.
Online criticism escalates	Acknowledge legitimate concerns, move complex individual matters to direct contact and keep public information factual.

9. Measurement

- Stakeholder enquiries and recurring themes
- Webpage visits around major notifications
- EDM open/click performance where available
- Timeliness of notifications against planned lead times
- Volume of avoidable complaints caused by missing or unclear information
- Project-team feedback on usefulness of communications support

SAMPLE NOTE

A live client version would normally include approved project details, named responsibilities, contact pathways, confirmed milestones and organisation-specific templates/branding.